

AI IN UX RESEARCH: COLLABORATION, NOT REPLACEMENT

The promise of AI

- **Automated Data Analysis**
- **Efficient, data-driven and user-focused design**
- **Facial recognition**
- **Much faster and efficient work**



Limitations

- **Bias - Major problem**
- **Trouble processing visual impacts**
- **Lack of citation and validation**
- **Limited understanding of context**
- **Vague summaries and recommendations**

Can AI replace UX researchers?

Can it understand cultural cues?

AI cannot replicate empathy and cultural understanding



Expert Opinions

Feifei Liu & Kate Moran: “*Current tools lack depth required for true insights*”

Gavin Lew & Robert M.Sch: “*AI needs UX for successful Commercialization*”

Join The Movement!

- **Embrace AI as a tool, not a replacement**
- **Advocate for ethical practice**
- **Share insights and collaborate to shape the future of UX research**

Your Voice Matters!!



User Experience Research: AI in UX research raises concerns about transparency, accuracy, and bias in data collection and analysis. Over-reliance on AI tools risks biased user experiences and may overlook valuable human-centered insights.

Does every culture communicate the same way? If AI can't grasp cultural context and nuances, can it truly replace human UX researchers, or is it just a tool to enhance the process, not replace them?

It's a common myth that AI and technological tools are replacing UX researchers and that they are not required, but is it really true? AI has indeed significantly transformed the methods used in user experience research, enhancing the accuracy of results and streamlining processes for greater efficiency.

Denisa Pricopi, a UX researcher at DataArt with over five years of experience says that the integration of AI into UX research represents a major advancement toward more efficient, data-driven, and user-focused design. By automating data analysis, forecasting user behavior, personalizing experiences, and leveraging advanced tools like natural language processing and facial recognition, UX researchers can uncover deeper insights into user interactions (Pricopi, 2024). It made processes much simpler sure but is it enough to completely replace humans? My answer would still be no.

For one, at least the available tools are not enough to do that. Feifei Liu, an international UX researcher working for Nielsen Norman Group, and Kate Moran, vice president of Nielsen Norman Group evaluated four new AI-powered UX research tools and concluded that “We do believe that user researchers will have good, reliable, useful AI-driven tools in the near future. They will make our work much faster and of higher quality. However, the currently available tools cannot provide those benefits yet” (Liu & Moran, 2024).

Some of the limitations they listed were Bias, which takes many forms, is pervasive throughout society, and can become embedded in the automated systems that influence decisions impacting our lives (Schwartz et al., 2022). Lack of citation and validation, limited understanding of the context, trouble processing visual inputs while doing user interviews, and vague summaries and recommendations, for example, one tool has made the following recommendations about a description page: Make sure that all the relevant information is easily accessible and clearly presented. Provide more detailed descriptions. This looks good but the problem with it is that it is really vague and doesn't specify what should be modified (Liu & Moran, 2024).

Can future AI tools overcome these limitations? Maybe, but I'm inclined to say no. Even the human brain, with its complex processes and empathy, struggles with bias and understanding different cultures. How can AI—trained on biased datasets—overcome bias and be truly fair?

According to Gavin Lew and Robert M. Sch, AI needs UX. They say, "As we are increasingly commercializing the AI in the product, branding issues surface. Just saying something has a "powerful AI engine" does not guarantee a sale. It needs more; it needs UX" (Lew & Schumacher, 2020). They also say that well-designed and carefully executed research programs can mitigate the limitations found in existing databases used to train AI algorithms. Researchers can avoid relying on incomplete, inaccurate, or flawed data with hidden limitations by utilizing custom datasets. UX researchers are well equipped to assist machine learning scientists in gathering clean, reliable datasets for training and testing AI algorithms (Lew & Schumacher, 2020).

It's time for us to band together and make a statement! Accept AI as a potent instrument, but tenaciously defend the human component, which forms the core of UX

research. Promote moral AI procedures, stimulate dialogue about cultural background, and intensify the debate regarding the critical role that human empathy plays in technology.

Let's lead the change rather than merely react to it! Give your opinions, work together with colleagues, and insist that human-centered research stays at the forefront of our discipline. Together, we can create a future in which artificial intelligence (AI) expands our knowledge, sharpens our insights, and improves user experience beyond anything previously possible. Join the movement and help define the future of UX research—your voice matters!

Citations

Lew, G., & Schumacher, R. M., Jr. (2020). *AI and UX: Why Artificial Intelligence Needs User Experience*. Apress.

Liu, F., & Moran, K. (2024, January 29). *AI-Powered Tools for UX Research: Issues and Limitations*. Nielsen Norman Group.

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ai-powered-tools-limitations/>

Pricopi, D. (2024, March 11). *7 Ways AI will Enhance UX Research*. Built In.

<https://builtin.com/articles/ai-enhance-ux-research>

Schwartz, R., Vassilev, A., Greene, K., Perine, L., Burt, A., & Hall, P. (2022). *Towards a standard for identifying and managing bias in artificial intelligence*.

<https://doi.org/10.6028/nist.sp.1270>